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Web Development Foundations

Week 1 - HTML: Something Exists
Day 2: "HTML Structure Iteration"

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Reconnect

Monday: one page existed.
Today: that page becomes a small site.

We will keep the first page and improve it:

- ▶ add structure
- ▶ add navigation
- ▶ add another page
- ▶ test movement between pages

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System

Pages are connected.
Not isolated.

- ▶ Each page is a file.
- ▶ Each file has an exact name.
- ▶ Links point to file names.
- ▶ Navigation lets the browser move through the site.



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From One Page to a Small Site

Monday: one page.
Wednesday: small site.



Iteration: keep the first page and grow it.

From Page to Site

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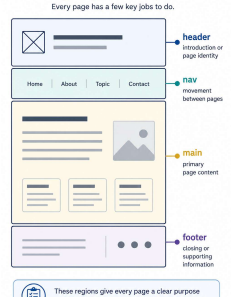
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Core Idea

Structure gives each part a job.

- ▶ 'header': introduction or page identity
- ▶ 'nav': movement between pages
- ▶ 'main': primary page content
- ▶ 'footer': closing or supporting information

HTML Page Regions: A Simple Wireframe
Every page has a few key jobs to do.



These regions give every page a clear purpose and help both users and code understand your site.

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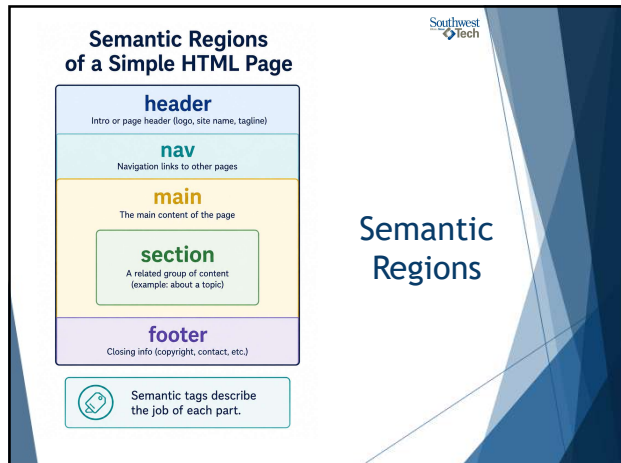
Semantic Regions

Use meaningful containers when the page has meaningful parts.

Semantic structure helps:

- ▶ readers understand the page
- ▶ future CSS target the right areas
- ▶ future JavaScript find the right areas
- ▶ you explain your own work

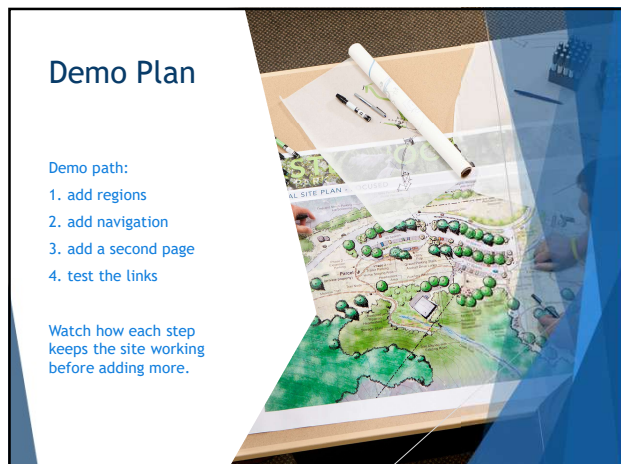
6



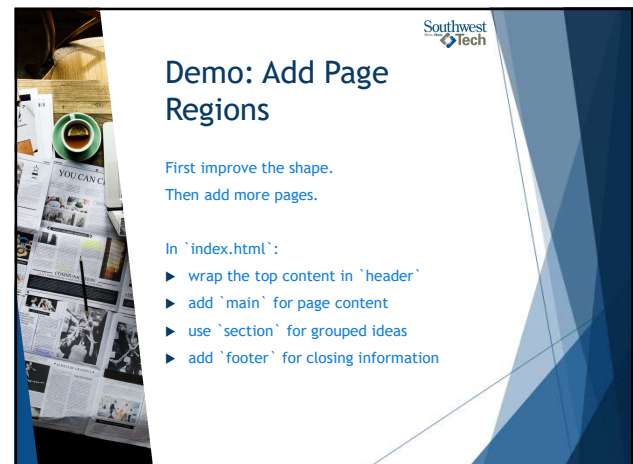
7



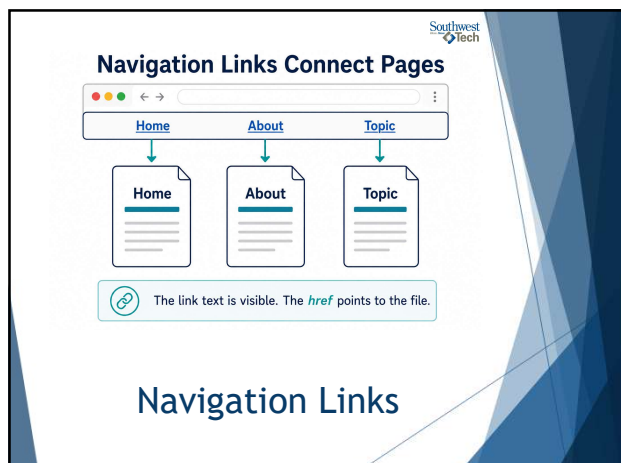
8



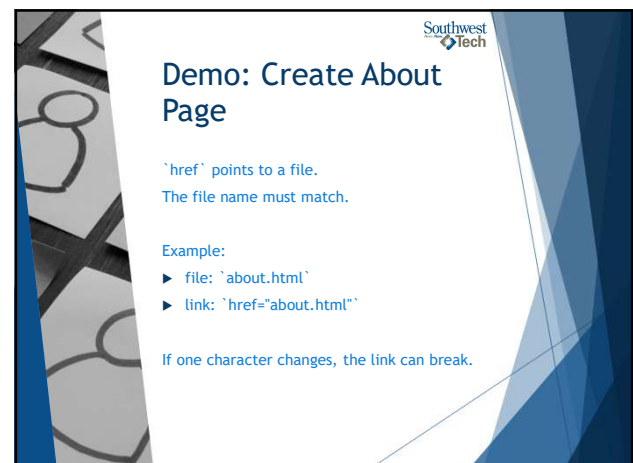
9



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Common Failure:

Exact-Match

Broken links are usually exact-match problems.

file name mismatch	wrong extension	missing file	wrong folder
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Debug by comparing the `href` to the actual file name.

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Why a Link Can Break:
Exact-Match Matters

File on your site: `about.html`

href value in your link: `abotU.html`

missing "u"

File names and href values must match exactly.

Common Failure:
Exact Matching

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Thinking Tool

Structure check:

- ▶ Can I explain each section?
- ▶ Do headings make sense?
- ▶ Can I move between pages?

If the answer is yes, the site is becoming easier to maintain.

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Improving Structure, Not Design

Before: Loosely Organized

After: Clear Structure

Refinement can mean *clearer structure*, not more decoration.

Structure Refinement

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Lab Refinement

Improve the first version.

- ▶ grow toward at least 3 pages
- ▶ fix links
- ▶ improve heading hierarchy
- ▶ clean content organization
- ▶ keep it HTML-only

Assignment target:

- ▶ multiple pages
- ▶ clear structure
- ▶ links between pages
- ▶ final reflection after refinement

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Evidence & Reflection

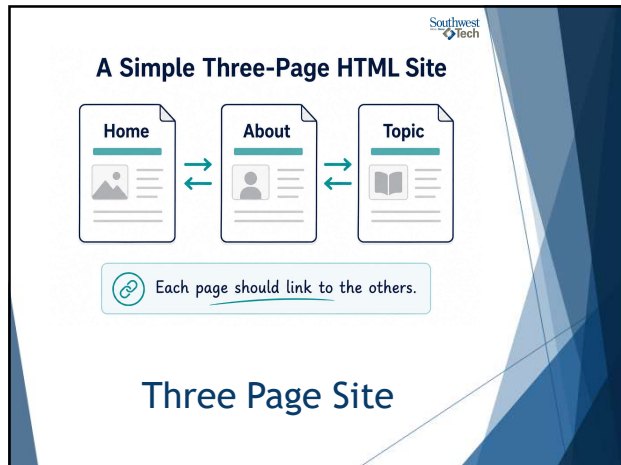
Submit:

- ▶ HTML files
- ▶ working navigation
- ▶ 2-3 sentence reflection

Reflection prompt:

What changed between your first version and final version, and why?

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How To Read Next Week's Material

Required: CSS rules and color.
Skim: text readability.
Reference: return during lab.

Focus on:

- ▶ what CSS changes
- ▶ how CSS connects to HTML
- ▶ how color and text affect readability

Do not memorize every CSS property.

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Closing Success Check

If someone can move through your site and understand it, your structure is working.

Before submitting, check:

- ▶ each page opens
- ▶ each link works
- ▶ each page has a clear purpose
- ▶ no CSS is required yet

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Thank you!

Have Fun!

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